Microsoft 365 Copilot

M365 Usage Dashboard Interpretation Guide

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The content in this interpretation guide is intended solely to help you better understand the structure and insights provided in the report. The charts here are based on demo data and your insights may look materially different.

Introduction

This guide walks through each page of the M365 Usage Dashboard and explains its purpose, how to read it, and suggestions for further analysis. The dashboard connects Microsoft Purview audit logs with Entra ID user data to surface M365 adoption, Copilot engagement, and license optimization opportunities.

Detailed Slide Interpretation

Walks through every slide in the dashboard, explaining the purpose of each visual, what to look for, and recommended next steps. Reference this section while reviewing the PDF to keep your story aligned with the visuals.

Questions?

Questions? Consult the FAQ and Glossary slides for additional context.

FAQ

Q: Who is included in these numbers?

A: All users present in the Purview audit export who had at least one M365 activity event during the selected date window. Copilot-specific metrics are further filtered to users with activity in Copilot surfaces.

Q: How often should we be refreshing the analysis?

A: Monthly is a good default. This gives enough time for behavioral patterns to form while keeping the data actionable for enablement teams.

Q: What time frame is each report measured on?

A: The date range reflects the window of your Purview audit export. All pages respect the Date slicer at the top right — adjust it to narrow or expand the analysis window.

Q: What is the difference between an action and an active day?

A: An action is a single event (e.g., a file view, a message sent, a Copilot prompt). An active day is any day on which a user recorded at least one action. Active days are used to measure engagement consistency — how many distinct days did users show up, not just how much they did.

Q: Are there prerequisites before relying on this analysis?

A: We recommend at least 8 weeks of audit data before drawing trend conclusions. Shorter windows can produce misleading spikes or drops due to holidays, onboarding waves, or data gaps.

Glossary

Active Day: Any calendar day on which a user recorded at least one M365 activity event

Active User: A user who recorded at least one action during the selected date window

Actions: Individual event-level records from the Purview audit log (file views, emails sent, meetings joined, Copilot prompts, etc.)

App Tier: A user's percentile rank within a specific M365 app relative to all other users (Top 10%, 10-25%, 25-50%, Bottom 50%)

Composite Score: A weighted 0-100 score combining a user's percentile across selected M365 apps; 80 = more active than 80% of peers

Copilot Users: Users who recorded at least one interaction in a Copilot surface (Teams Copilot, Word Copilot, Excel Copilot, etc.)

Enablement Gap: The difference between a user's M365 activity percentile and their Copilot activity percentile — large gap = high M365 reliance with low Copilot adoption

Engagement Segment: Classification by active days: Daily (20+ days), Frequent (11-19), Moderate (6-10), Infrequent (1-5), Inactive (0)

hasLicense: Boolean field from Entra ID indicating whether a user has an assigned M365 Copilot license

Operation: The specific action type recorded in the Purview log (e.g., Send, FileViewed, CopilotInteraction, MeetingParticipated)

SourceFileExtension: File type involved in the event — used to route Word (.docx), Excel (.xlsx), and PowerPoint (.pptx) activity

Workload: The M365 service that generated the event (Exchange, MicrosoftTeams, SharePoint, OneDrive, Copilot)

Detailed Slide Interpretation

1

What are the top-line adoption metrics for this organization?

INTERPRETATION: The six KPI cards show total M365 Users, Teams Activity, Email Activity, Document Activity, Copilot Users, and Departments Tracked. Compare M365 Users to Copilot Users — the gap represents the unlicensed population with the highest licensing potential.

RECOMMENDATION: Use these cards as your opening benchmark numbers. If Copilot Users equals M365 Users, all active users have Copilot. Any gap is your addressable licensing universe.

2

Which M365 apps are driving the most activity, and what types of actions?

INTERPRETATION: The bar chart breaks down total events by app (Teams, Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint) and sub-metric (Emails Read, Emails Sent, Meetings, Messages Sent, Uploads, Views, Edits, Downloads). Teams dominating is typical; low document app volume relative to Teams signals an opportunity to amplify Copilot for content workflows.

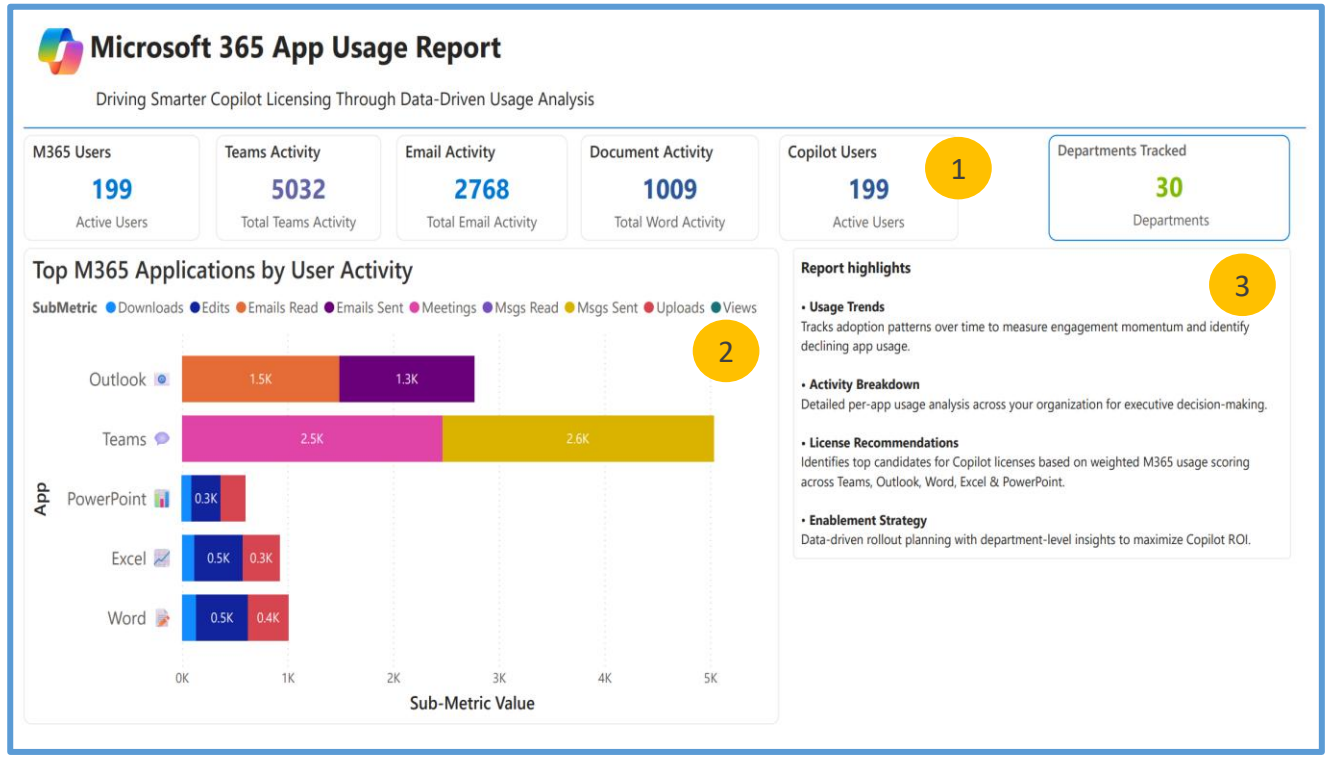
GUIDANCE: Compare Emails Read vs. Emails Sent to assess whether Outlook usage is consumption-heavy or communication-heavy. High Reads relative to Sends may indicate passive email users who aren't strong Copilot candidates for drafting features.

RECOMMENDATION: Use the sub-metric legend to identify which action types drive each app's total. Apps with high activity in file-interaction sub-metrics (Views, Edits, Uploads) are the strongest candidates for Copilot for Word, Excel, and PowerPoint enablement.

3

How do I use the Report Highlights panel to navigate the dashboard?

INTERPRETATION: The right-side panel lists the four main analytical sections: Usage Trends, Activity Breakdown, License Recommendations, and Enablement Strategy. Each entry summarizes what that section covers.



1

What are the overall activity totals and how does the date filter affect them?

INTERPRETATION: The four KPI cards (Total Users, Active M365 Users, M365 All Apps Actions, Avg Actions Per User) update dynamically with the date slicer. The date range shown here is September 2025 — adjust this to reflect your organization's reporting window.

RECOMMENDATION: Start by setting the date range to the last 30 days to establish a recent baseline, then extend to 3 months to see longer-term trends.

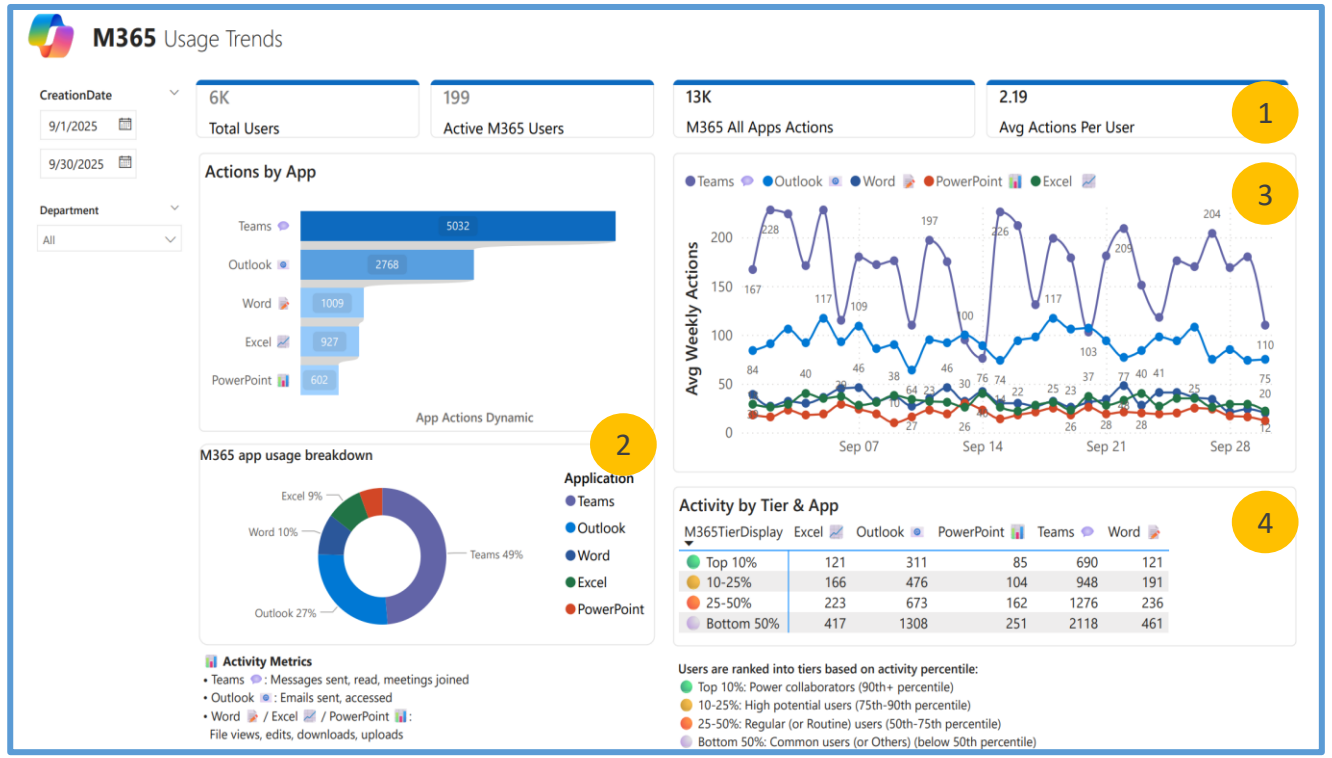
2

Which apps are driving the most total activity?

INTERPRETATION: The Actions by App bar chart ranks apps by total event count. Teams is typically the dominant app due to high-frequency chat and meeting events. The donut chart below shows the percentage share — use this to understand which apps own your organization's M365 footprint.

GUIDANCE: A very high Teams share (50%+) combined with low document-app share (<10% each for Word/Excel/PowerPoint) indicates your workforce is primarily collaborative but document workflows have room to grow — ideal for Copilot for content creation.

RECOMMENDATION: Filter by a specific department using the left panel to see if app distribution differs significantly across teams.



3

How is app usage trending week over week?

INTERPRETATION: The line chart on the right shows average weekly actions per app over time. Steady growth indicates sustained adoption momentum. Spikes may reflect training events or new feature launches — check if usage sustains after the spike.

GUIDANCE: If a line dips and recovers, investigate whether an external factor (holidays, org changes) caused the drop. Persistent decline in a specific app is an early signal for targeted enablement.

4

How does activity break down across user tiers and apps?

INTERPRETATION: The Activity by Tier & App table segments users into Top 10%, 10-25%, 25-50%, and Bottom 50% based on overall M365 percentile. Higher tiers should show disproportionately higher per-app activity.

RECOMMENDATION: If your Bottom 50% drives most of the absolute volume, you have broad but shallow adoption. Focus enablement on converting Moderate and Infrequent users to more consistent habits.

1

What are the headline metrics for user engagement?

INTERPRETATION: The four KPI cards (Total Users, M365 Actions, Avg Actions Per Week, Avg Active Days) give a snapshot of overall engagement depth. Avg Active Days is the most important metric — it reflects how many distinct calendar days users showed up in M365, not just their raw action count.

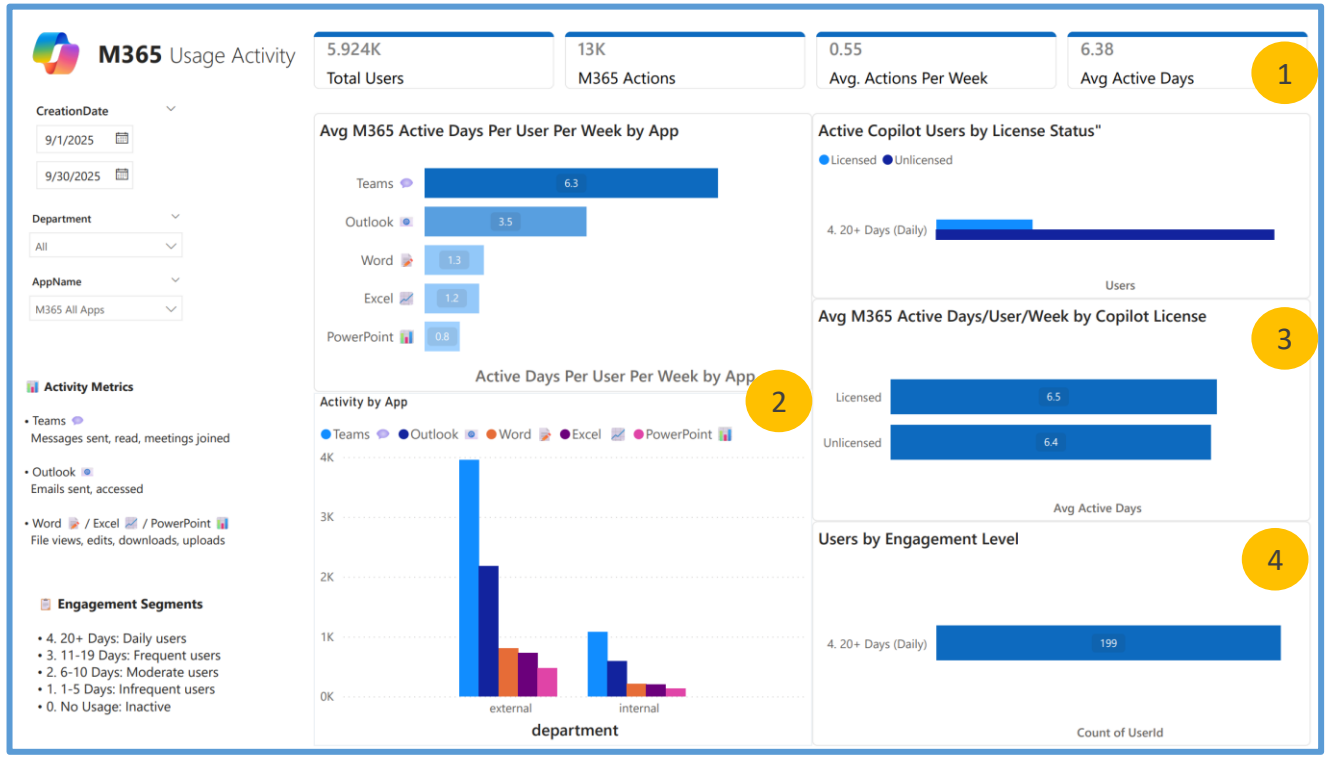
RECOMMENDATION: Track Avg Active Days over time. An increase indicates users are building more consistent M365 habits, which directly correlates with Copilot readiness.

2

Which apps see the most consistent daily use, and which are occasional?

INTERPRETATION: The Avg Active Days Per User Per Week bar chart shows app consistency. Teams near 6 days means near-daily use. Word, Excel, and PowerPoint at 1-1.5 days means users engage with those apps only 1-2 times per week — these users benefit most from Copilot features that reduce the effort of occasional document work.

GUIDANCE: Users with high Teams active days but low document-app active days are strong candidates for Copilot in Teams. Users with high Word/Excel days are strong candidates for Copilot for document apps.



3

Are licensed Copilot users more active in M365 than unlicensed users?

INTERPRETATION: The Avg Active Days by Copilot License chart compares licensed vs. unlicensed users. If the difference is small, licensed users may not have fully integrated Copilot into their workflows yet — an enablement signal.

RECOMMENDATION: If unlicensed users are nearly as active as licensed users, prioritize Copilot enablement for licensed users before expanding licensing further.

4

How are users distributed across engagement segments?

INTERPRETATION: The Users by Engagement Level chart groups users by active day count: Daily (20+ days), Frequent (11-19), Moderate (6-10), Infrequent (1-5), Inactive (0). A healthy adoption curve has a growing Daily segment and shrinking Infrequent/Inactive segments over time.

RECOMMENDATION: Target Moderate users (6-10 days) first for enablement — they are already engaged enough to build habits but need a nudge. Infrequent users may need more fundamental onboarding.

1

How is the composite score calculated for each user?

INTERPRETATION: Every user receives a score from 0-100 based on their weighted percentile rank in each M365 app. A score of 80 means the user is more active than 80% of peers in that app. The score is the weighted average across all selected apps.

GUIDANCE: The default profile weights Copilot Chat at 100%, which scores users entirely on their existing Copilot Chat activity. Switch to Balanced or Collaboration Focus to score users on broader M365 behavior.

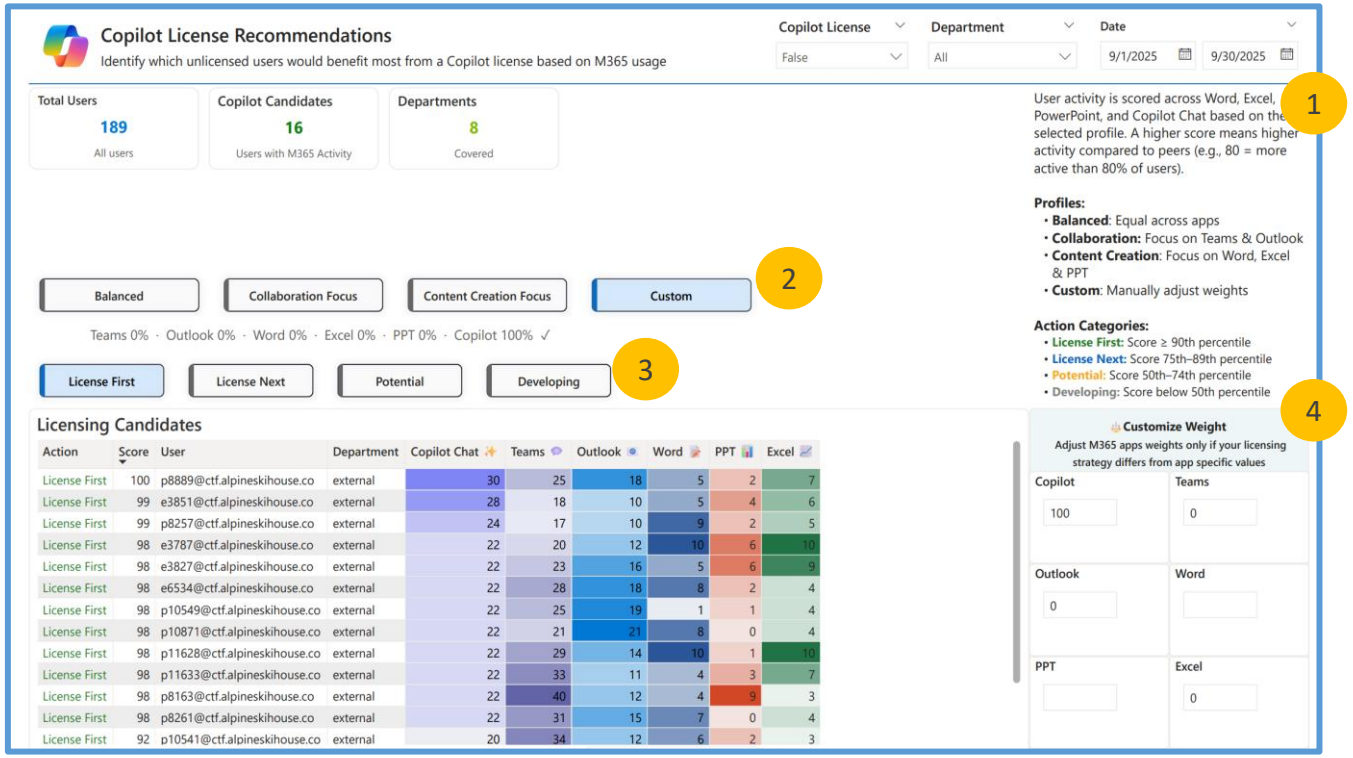
2

Which profile should I select, and how do the weights work?

INTERPRETATION: The four profile buttons (Balanced, Collaboration Focus, Content Creation, Custom) set the weight each app contributes to the composite score. Balanced weights all apps equally. Collaboration Focus prioritizes Teams and Outlook. Content Creation prioritizes Word, Excel, and PowerPoint.

GUIDANCE: Use Custom to manually set weights that reflect your organization's planned Copilot use cases. Higher weight = more influence on the final score. The weights shown below each profile button show the current distribution.

RECOMMENDATION: If your Copilot rollout prioritizes meetings and chat use cases, use Collaboration Focus. If document productivity is the goal, use Content Creation.



Action	Score	User	Department	Copilot Chat	Teams	Outlook	Word	PPT	Excel
License First	100	p8889@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	30	25	18	5	2	7
License First	99	e3851@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	28	18	10	5	4	6
License First	99	p8257@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	24	17	10	9	2	5
License First	98	e3787@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	22	20	12	10	6	10
License First	98	e3827@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	22	23	16	5	6	9
License First	98	e6534@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	22	28	18	8	2	4
License First	98	p10549@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	22	25	19	1	1	4
License First	98	p10871@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	22	21	21	8	0	4
License First	98	p11628@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	22	29	14	10	1	10
License First	98	p11633@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	22	33	11	4	3	7
License First	98	p8163@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	22	40	12	4	9	3
License First	98	p8261@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	22	31	15	7	0	4
License First	92	p10541@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	20	34	12	6	2	3

3

How do action categories translate to license deployment waves?

INTERPRETATION: License First users (score at or above 90th percentile) should be prioritized for immediate licensing. License Next (75th-89th) is your second wave. Potential (50th-74th) needs enablement before licensing. Developing (below 50th) requires foundational M365 engagement first.

RECOMMENDATION: Sort the Licensing Candidates table by Score descending. Start with all License First rows, then schedule License Next for the next quarter.

4

How do I use the Customize Weight panel?

INTERPRETATION: The Customize Weight panel (right side of the page) lets you enter a manual weight for each app independently. This is the Custom profile — change any value and the table re-ranks instantly.

RECOMMENDATION: Set Copilot Chat weight to 0 and run Balanced weights if you want to license users based purely on M365 behavior without penalizing those who haven't yet used Copilot Chat.

How the Composite Score Works

Score Calculation

Each user receives a percentile rank within each M365 app relative to all other users. A score of 80 means more active than 80% of peers in that app. The composite score is the weighted average of these per-app percentiles.

Profile Presets

- Balanced: Equal weights across Teams, Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint — good for general licensing decisions.
- Collaboration Focus: Heavy weight on Teams and Outlook — best when your Copilot rollout prioritizes meeting and email productivity.
- Content Creation: Heavy weight on Word, Excel, PowerPoint — best when document workflow productivity is the primary goal.
- Custom: You set the weight for each app manually. Weights do not need to sum to 100.

Action Category Thresholds

- License First: Score at or above 90th percentile — license immediately
- License Next: Score at 75th-89th percentile — strong candidate for next wave
- Potential: Score at 50th-74th percentile — provide enablement before licensing
- Developing: Score below 50th percentile — focus on foundational M365 engagement first

Key Tip

Changing the profile instantly re-ranks all users. Use this to model different licensing scenarios before committing to a wave. Try running Balanced, Collaboration Focus, and Content Creation profiles and compare which users appear in License First across all three — those are your safest first-wave candidates.

1

What does the Priority score represent, and how are users assigned to quadrants?

INTERPRETATION: Priority is based on how much users rely on M365 apps compared to how much they currently use Copilot. High M365 usage with low Copilot usage = high priority. Users are placed in one of four quadrants: Enablement Targets (high M365, low Copilot), Champions (high M365, high Copilot), AI-First (low M365, high Copilot), Low Engagement (low on both).

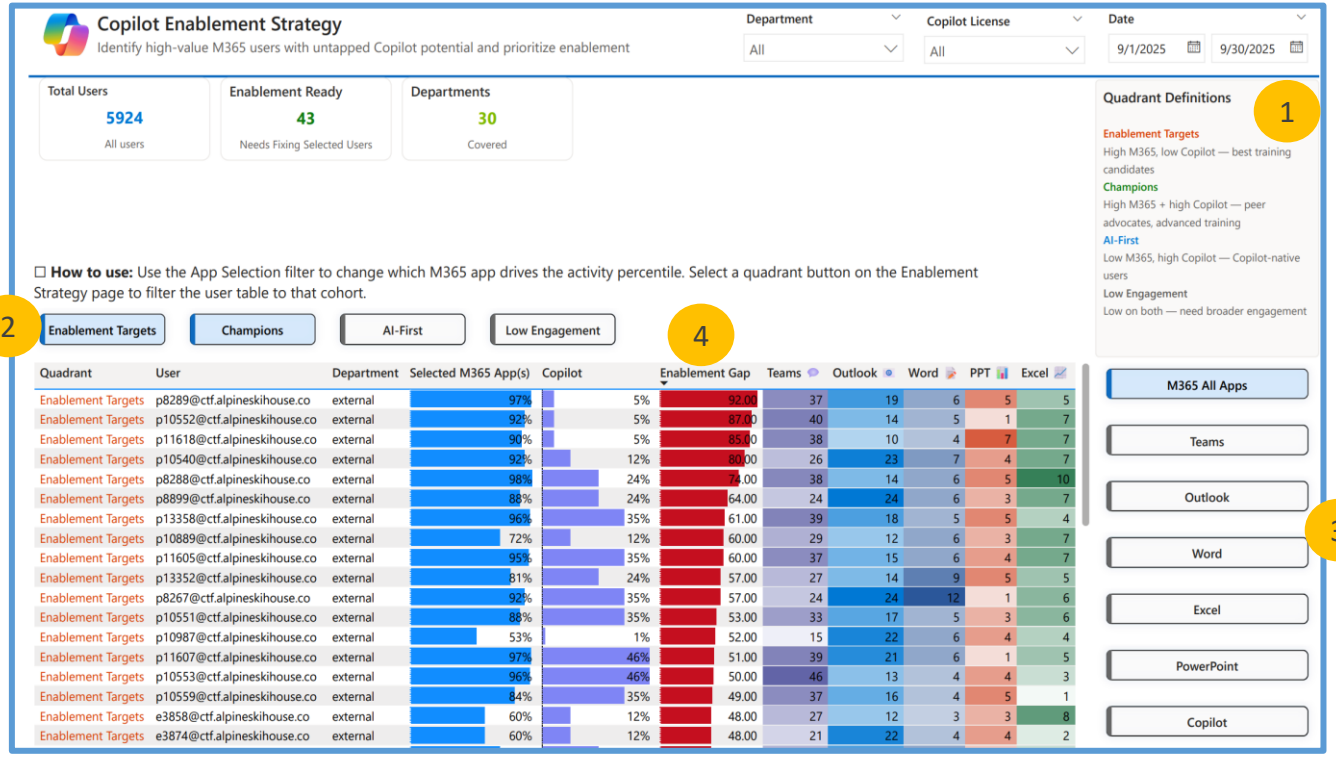
RECOMMENDATION: Click the Enablement Targets button first. These are your highest-ROI training candidates — they have the M365 foundation and just need targeted prompting and use-case content.

2

How do I use the quadrant filter buttons?

INTERPRETATION: The four quadrant buttons (Enablement Targets, Champions, AI-First, Low Engagement) filter the user table to show only users in that quadrant. Click Deselect All to see the full population again.

GUIDANCE: Champions (high M365, high Copilot) are your peer advocates. Capture their usage patterns and use them to build enablement content for Enablement Targets. AI-First users have high Copilot usage despite lower M365 engagement — investigate what workflows are driving their Copilot adoption.



Quadrant	User	Department	Selected M365 App(s)	Copilot	Enablement Gap	Teams	Outlook	Word	PPT	Excel
Enablement Targets	p8289@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	97%	5%	92.00	37	19	6	5	5
Enablement Targets	p10552@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	92%	5%	87.00	40	14	5	1	7
Enablement Targets	p11618@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	90%	5%	85.00	38	10	4	7	7
Enablement Targets	p10540@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	92%	12%	80.00	26	23	7	4	7
Enablement Targets	p8288@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	98%	24%	74.00	38	14	6	5	10
Enablement Targets	p8899@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	88%	24%	64.00	24	24	6	3	7
Enablement Targets	p13358@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	96%	35%	61.00	39	18	5	5	4
Enablement Targets	p10889@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	72%	12%	60.00	29	12	6	3	7
Enablement Targets	p11605@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	95%	35%	60.00	37	15	6	4	7
Enablement Targets	p13352@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	81%	24%	57.00	27	14	9	5	5
Enablement Targets	p8267@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	92%	35%	57.00	24	24	12	1	6
Enablement Targets	p10551@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	88%	35%	53.00	33	17	5	3	6
Enablement Targets	p10987@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	53%	1%	52.00	15	22	6	4	4
Enablement Targets	p11607@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	97%	46%	51.00	39	21	6	1	5
Enablement Targets	p10553@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	96%	46%	50.00	46	13	4	4	3
Enablement Targets	p10559@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	84%	35%	49.00	37	16	4	5	1
Enablement Targets	e3858@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	60%	12%	48.00	27	12	3	3	8
Enablement Targets	e3874@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	external	60%	12%	48.00	21	22	4	4	2

3

How does the App Selection filter change the quadrant assignments?

INTERPRETATION: The App Selection buttons (M365 All Apps, Teams, Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Copilot) change which M365 app drives the activity percentile axis. Selecting Teams shows who is a high Teams user vs. a high Copilot user specifically.

RECOMMENDATION: Run through each app selection to identify workflow-specific quadrants. A user who appears in Enablement Targets for Word but Champions for Teams needs targeted Copilot for Word training, not general enablement.

4

How does the Enablement Gap column help me prioritize?

INTERPRETATION: The Enablement Gap is the difference between the user's M365 activity percentile and their Copilot activity percentile. A large red number means the user is very active in M365 but barely using Copilot — they have the skill foundation and just need targeted prompting.

RECOMMENDATION: Sort by Enablement Gap descending to find users with the strongest adoption signal. These users are the fastest to convert through targeted training because they already rely heavily on M365.

1

What do the Priority and Action columns tell me for each user?

INTERPRETATION: Priority (Promoter/Medium/High/Critical/Low) reflects how urgently the user needs Copilot enablement. Action (Advanced Training/Immediate Training/Train Next/Monitor) is the recommended next step. Both are driven by the ratio of M365 activity to current Copilot usage.

RECOMMENDATION: Export the table filtered to Critical and High priority for your outreach team. These users have strong M365 habits and are primed for Copilot adoption.

2

What do App Tier and Copilot Tier tell me when read together?

INTERPRETATION: App Tier (Top 10%, 10-25%, 25-50%, Bottom 50%) shows where the user sits among all peers in the selected M365 app. Copilot Tier shows the same ranking for Copilot usage. A user with Top 10% App Tier and Bottom 50% Copilot Tier has strong M365 habits but hasn't adopted Copilot — this is your ideal enablement target.

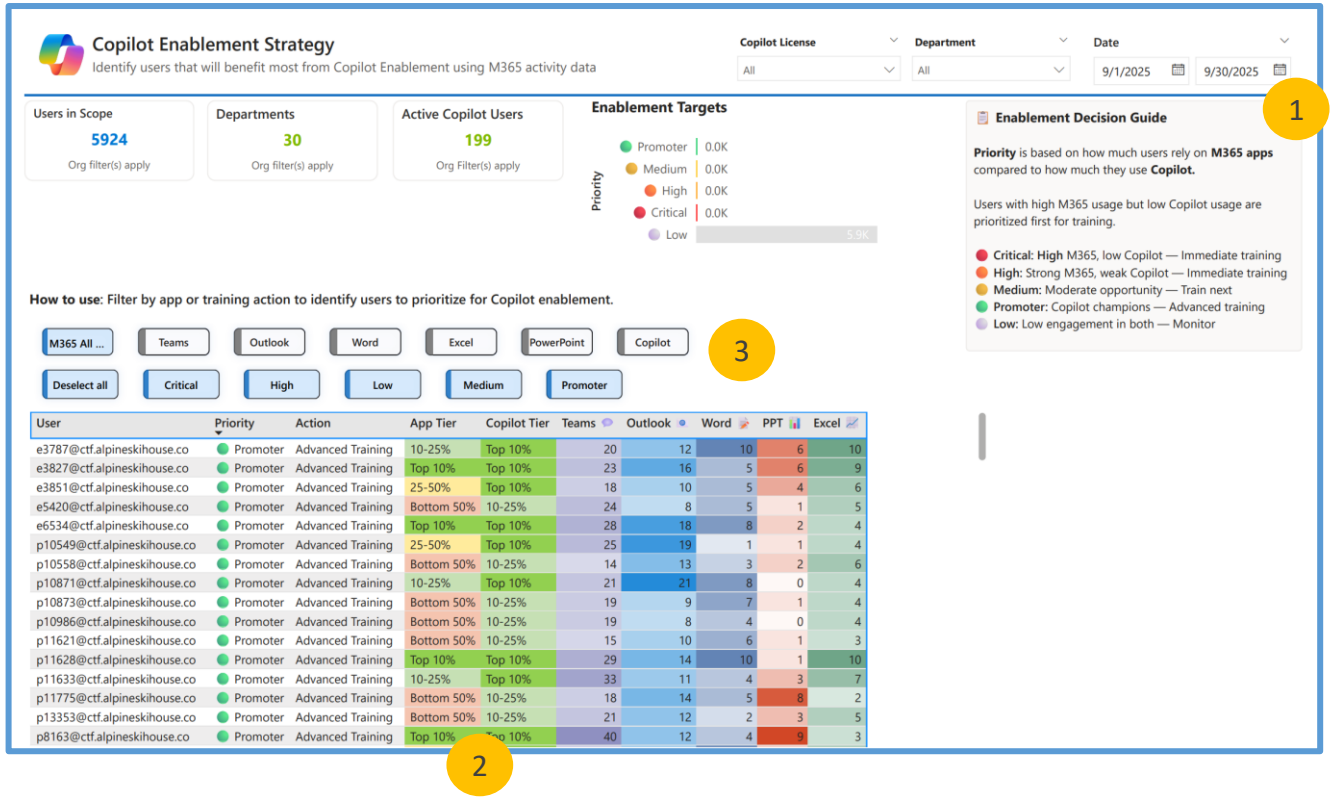
GUIDANCE: A user with Bottom 50% App Tier and Top 10% Copilot Tier is an AI-First user — they adopted Copilot independently. Consider whether they need additional M365 training to realize more value.

3

How do I use the app and priority filter buttons at the top?

INTERPRETATION: The 7 app buttons (M365 All Apps, Teams, Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Copilot) change which app's tier drives the ranking. The priority buttons (Critical, High, Medium, Promoter, Low) filter the table to show only that priority level.

RECOMMENDATION: Select a specific app (e.g., Word) and filter to Critical + High priority to generate a targeted list for Copilot for Word training outreach.



User	Priority	Action	App Tier	Copilot Tier	Teams	Outlook	Word	PPT	Excel
e3787@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	10-25%	Top 10%	20	12	10	6	10
e3827@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Top 10%	Top 10%	23	16	5	6	9
e3851@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	25-50%	Top 10%	18	10	5	4	6
e5420@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Bottom 50%	10-25%	24	8	5	1	5
e6534@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Top 10%	Top 10%	28	18	8	2	4
p10549@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	25-50%	Top 10%	25	19	1	1	4
p10558@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Bottom 50%	10-25%	14	13	3	2	6
p10871@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	10-25%	Top 10%	21	21	8	0	4
p10873@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Bottom 50%	10-25%	19	9	7	1	4
p10986@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Bottom 50%	10-25%	19	8	4	0	4
p11621@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Bottom 50%	10-25%	15	10	6	1	3
p11628@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Top 10%	Top 10%	29	14	10	1	10
p11633@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	10-25%	Top 10%	33	11	4	3	7
p11775@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Bottom 50%	10-25%	18	14	5	8	2
p13353@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Bottom 50%	10-25%	21	12	2	3	5
p8163@ctf.alpineskihouse.co	Promoter	Advanced Training	Top 10%	Top 10%	40	12	4	9	3

1

What do the four licensing tiers represent?

INTERPRETATION: The Licensing Strategy Guide panel (right of page) defines four tiers: Prioritize (top M365 users — license immediately), License Next (strong candidates for next wave), Enablement (moderate usage — train before licensing), Monitor (low activity — revisit later). Tier membership is determined automatically by overall M365 activity percentile.

RECOMMENDATION: Use the user counts in each tier as your license wave planning numbers. Tier 1 (Prioritize) count = immediate licenses needed. Tier 2 count = next-quarter budget.

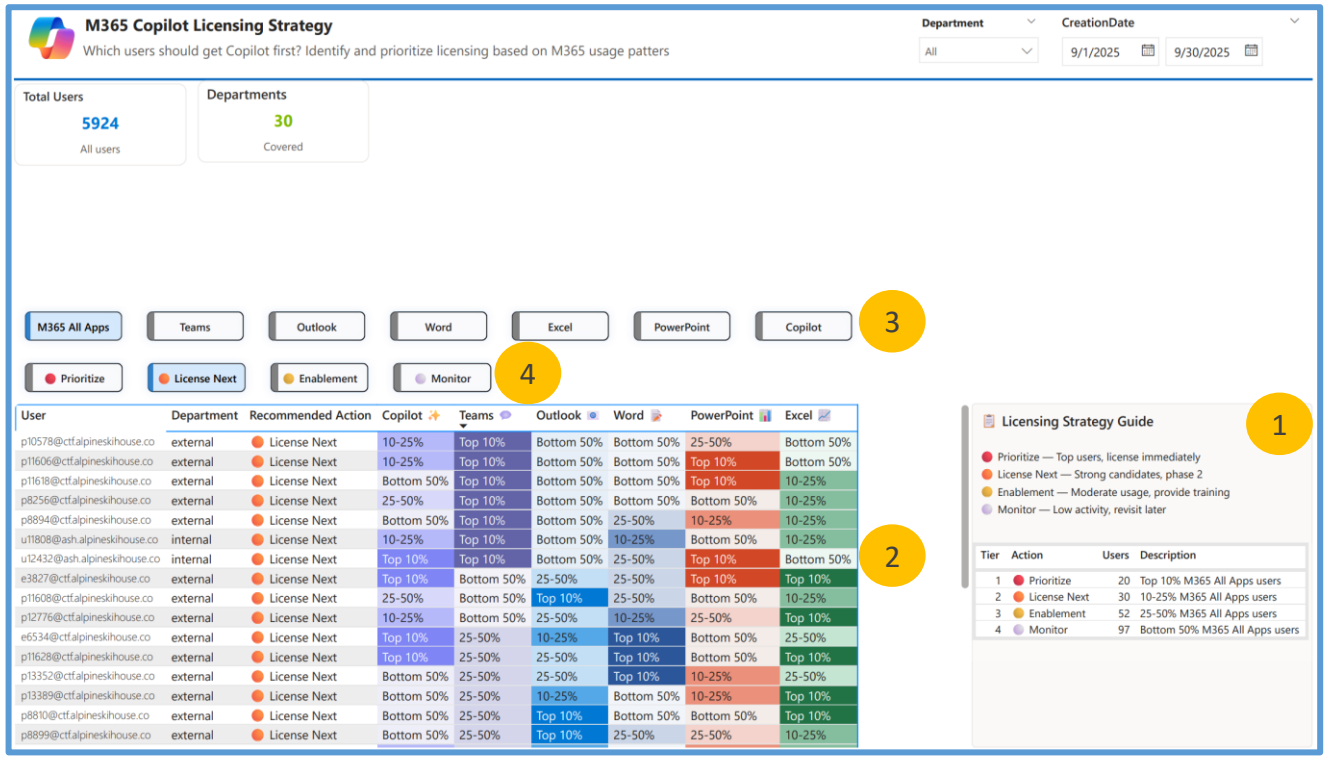
2

What do the color-coded tier cells tell me for each user?

INTERPRETATION: Each cell in the Teams, Outlook, Word, PowerPoint, and Excel columns shows that user's activity tier in that specific app. Top 10% is green, 10-25% is yellow, 25-50% is orange, Bottom 50% is white. Reading across a row shows you a user's full M365 profile.

GUIDANCE: A user showing Top 10% in Outlook but Bottom 50% in Teams has a communication-strong but collaboration-weak profile. When onboarding them to Copilot, lead with Copilot for Outlook use cases rather than Teams meeting summaries.

RECOMMENDATION: Look for users with Top 10% in multiple apps — these are well-rounded heavy users who will see Copilot ROI across many surfaces and should be first-wave priorities.



3

How does the App Selection filter change the recommended action?

INTERPRETATION: The 7 app selection buttons change the scoring basis. Selecting Teams re-ranks users based on Teams-only activity and recalculates tier membership and recommended action. This lets you generate a licensing list optimized for a specific workflow.

RECOMMENDATION: Run the filter once with M365 All Apps (holistic view) and once with your primary Copilot use case app. Compare the License First lists — users appearing in both are your most defensible first-wave candidates.

4

How do I use the Prioritize and License Next filter buttons?

INTERPRETATION: The action tier buttons (Prioritize, License Next, Enablement, Monitor) filter the table to show only users in that recommended action category. This turns the full table into an actionable outreach list.

RECOMMENDATION: Click Prioritize, then export the table. This is your Tier 1 license request list. Repeat with License Next for Tier 2.